Social Media Resource Pack

JANUARY 2023

This Mum Moves™ is an educational programme which aims to empower women to make informed physical activity choices throughout pregnancy and beyond by providing professionals with the tools to discuss physical activity during the childbearing years.

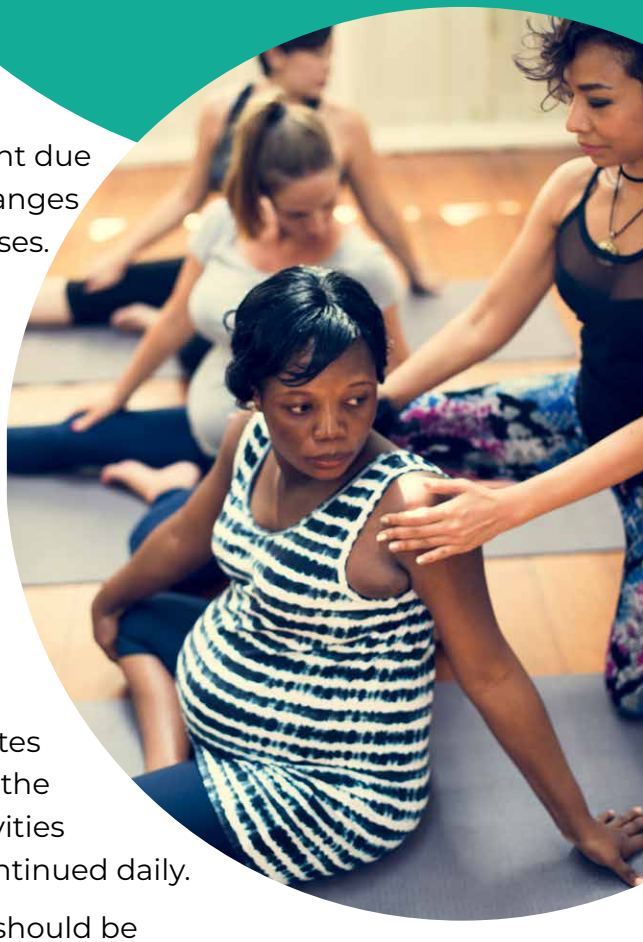
This social media resource pack has been produced with This Mum Moves (TMM) Ambassadors in mind, to have the communication tools and narrative to reach out to pregnant and postnatal women. The pack provides key messaging, suggested social media posts and assets, it is therefore essential that TMM Ambassadors adapt to the narrative, language and signposting to target the audience (pregnant and postnatal women).

Together we want to improve the physical and mental health of pregnant women and new mums by reducing the decline in physical activity engagement during the childbearing years.

The call for action to TMM Ambassadors is to understand the key messages below, and to use this social media resource pack to raise awareness, bust myths, and change the narrative around an active motherhood, through their social media channels.

Key Messages

- Collectively we want to improve the physical and mental health of women by reducing the decline in physical activity levels during and after pregnancy but we also know, that every pregnancy and postnatal journey will be different.
- The UK Chief Medical Officers' Physical Activity Guidelines (2019) recommend that women with uncomplicated pregnancies aim to accumulate 150 minutes of moderate intensity physical activity throughout the week and engage in 8–12 repetitions of muscle-strengthening activities involving the major muscle groups twice per week.
- Women who are healthy, have an uncomplicated pregnancy, and already active, can continue to be physically active but adaptation may be required as pregnancy progresses.
- Women who are healthy, have an uncomplicated pregnancy, and new to activity, should start gradually and then build up their activity levels.
- Key benefits of being active during pregnancy are: helps to reduce high blood pressure problems, helps to prevent diabetes of pregnancy, helps to control weight gain, improves fitness, improves sleep, improves mood.
- There is no evidence of harm to mum or baby where healthy women with uncomplicated pregnancies engage in moderate intensity physical activities.



- During pregnancy, some activities may feel different due to the associated anatomical and physiological changes and may require adaptation as pregnancy progresses. As a general rule: If it feels pleasant, keep going! If it is uncomfortable, stop and seek advice.
- Where adapting or selecting physical activities, pregnant women should avoid activities that puts them at risk of falling, contact injuries, direct trauma...don't bump the bump!
- The UK Chief Medical Officers' Physical Activity Guidelines (2019) recommend that after childbirth, and depending on birth experience, recovery, and previous physical activity levels, women should gradually build back up to accumulating 150 minutes of moderate intensity physical activity throughout the week and engaging in muscle-strengthening activities twice per week. Pelvic floor exercises should be continued daily.
- Reintroduction of physical activity after childbirth should be gradual and individualised.
- Following a straightforward birth, women can start gentle, low intensity activities as soon as they feel up to it. This could include walking, gentle stretches, pelvic floor exercises, and exercises that target the deepest layer of the abdominal muscles.
- The 6-8 week postnatal check is a good time to discuss physical activity and any related concerns with a healthcare professional.
- Moderate intensity physical activities should be built up gradually. With any signs and symptoms of pelvic floor and/or abdominal wall dysfunction, more intense activities should not resume and referral to a specialist pelvic health physiotherapist is recommended.
- Breastfeeding when being active at a moderate intensity or when taking part in strength training is safe and does not impact on breast milk quality or infant growth.
- Key benefits of being active following childbirth are: reduces worries and depression, helps to control weight and return to pre-pregnancy weight, improves tummy muscle tone and strength, improves fitness, improves mood, improves sleep.

- Whether pregnant or postnatal, physical activity should be adapted to the individual and their circumstances. This does not always mean structured exercise in a class setting, gym environment, or within a leisure facility. Physical activity can take place at home (everyday household chores, home workouts) or outdoors (walking, cycling, gardening).
- Whether pregnant or postnatal, women should be advised to consult a healthcare professional if they have any concerns or notice anything unusual. Remember the golden rule: If it feels good, keep going! If it is uncomfortable, stop and seek advice.
- The Talk Test is a simple measure of relative physical activity intensity. Moderate intensity is described as an activity that makes you breathe faster whilst still being able to hold a conversation but not being able to sing.
- Move more and move more often. It's recommended that pregnant and postnatal women limit the amount of time spent sedentary. Prolonged periods of sitting should be broken up with at least light intensity physical activity.

Social Media Content Examples

Below are some examples of content for social media posts, which you can adapt for each platform:

- Calling all #pregnant and #postnatal women to #BeActive. Join the thousands of women finding ways to enjoy and benefit from being active during motherhood.

  Find out more: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org
- Being active is great for your physical and mental health! If you are healthy, have an uncomplicated pregnancy, and already active, it is safe to continue being active.

  Check out our resources and top tips on how to stay active during your pregnancy and beyond: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org
- If you weren't active before your pregnancy, don't worry. If you are healthy and have an uncomplicated pregnancy, starting gradually and building up your activity levels now will make a big difference to your health and wellbeing.

  Check out our resources and top tips on how to you can build your activity levels during your pregnancy and beyond: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org
- Gradually building up your activity levels after childbirth will have many benefits to your physical and mental wellbeing. Have a look at our range of resources to support you in your physical activity journey: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org

- There are many health benefits to being active during your #pregnancy:
  - Helps to reduce high blood pressure problems.
  - Helps to prevent diabetes of pregnancy.
  - Helps to control weight gain.
  - Improves fitness.
  - Improves sleep.
  - Improves mood.

  Learn more about these benefits and discover a whole range of resources to support your journey: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/
- Congratulations on your pregnancy! Have you had your booking appointment yet? This is a great time to discuss how physical activity can benefit your physical and mental health. Read, then take this leaflet with you to your next appointment: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/thismummoves-pregnancy-leaflet
- There are many health benefits to being active after childbirth.
  - Reduces worries and depression.
  - Helps to control weight and return to pre-pregnancy weight.
  - Improves tummy muscle tone and strength.
  - Improves fitness.
  - Improves sleep.
  - Improves mood.

  Learn more about these benefits and a whole range of resources to support your journey: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/
- Being active during pregnancy and after having a baby doesn't always mean attending an exercise class or going to a gym. Household chores, gardening, playing with the children, walking the dog...every activity counts! #FindYourActive and do it your way: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/findyouractive

- Not sure where to start? Want to try something different? Check out the #ThisMumMoves #ActiveAtHome resource and give something a go today! www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/thismummoves-activeathome
- Are you due your 6-8 week postnatal check-up? This is a great time to discuss physical activity and to ask specific questions about your physical and mental health. Read, then take this leaflet with you to your next appointment: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/thismummoves-postnatal-leaflet
- In your place, at your pace! Check out the free, online Couch to Fitness #Prenatal 6-week exercise programme hosted by qualified instructors. You don't need any equipment and it is suitable for all fitness levels. couchtofitness.com/prenatal
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- #KeepMoving, you don't have to do structured exercises to reap the benefits of physical activity. Every movement counts!, Sit less, move more, feel great! Learn how you can keep moving through motherhood: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/
- Are you #pregnant or #postnatal and have questions on physical activity? Have a look at our website and the range of resources to support you in making informed decisions throughout your journey: www.activepregnancyfoundation.org/

The Active Pregnancy Foundation Social Media Platforms and Handles

@PregnancyActive

@ActivePregnancyFoundation

@ActivePregnancyFoundation

@ActivePregnancyFoundation

Suggested Hashtags

#ThisMumMoves
#ActivePregnancy
#ActiveMum
#BeActive
#KeepMoving
#ThisMumMovesAmbassador
#ActivePregnancyFoundation
#MovingThroughMotherhood
#JoinTheMovement
#SitLessMoveMore

Guidelines on Using Hashtags and Tagging

There are specific guidelines to follow for each social network that will help increase overall social media exposure. Hashtags and tagging is a way to add metadata to content that is published on social media so that it is easier to be found, followed, and understood by people and social media sites.

A hashtag starts with the # symbol and is followed by a word or words without spaces e.g. #ThisMumMoves. They are very easy to use and can make your social media postings shareable and discoverable if they are used correctly.

Different from hashtagging, tagging refers to using a social handle or username of a person or organisation in your post or photo and linking them to it. To tag, simply type the @ symbol and then the start of the person's or organisation's profile name e.g. @ActivePregnancyFoundation.

There are many benefits of using hashtags and tagging in social media posts.

See below for some general guidance:

- Users following the particular hashtag can see your posts even if they are not part of your followers. In other words, by using popular hashtags in your posts you can reach a larger audience.
- You can hashtag or tag #ThisMumMoves and @ActivePregnancyFoundation to an existing trending story to maximise reach and exposure.
- A hashtag becomes trending when a large number of people use it in their messages.
- Tagging relevant organisations is important, this will link the organisation to the post and encourage engagement and further reach and exposure. For example, on Instagram we suggest tagging: @ActivePregnancyFoundation @iHealthVisiting @OfficialSportEngland @ThisGirlCanUK
- Always encourage engagement; like, comment, share, repost. Do this by tagging/mentioning relevant person(s) and organisations and hashtagging relevant campaigns.

- Hashtags make it easier for social networks to categorise updates and this makes them more visible to search results. For example, by adding the hashtag #ThisMumMoves on a tweet, you give the indication to Twitter that your tweet is about Mums and active/movement. This means that it will appear in the search results when users search for SEO on Twitter.
- Hashtags are heavily searched on Instagram and are a way for people to discover new accounts to follow. It is recommended using ten to twelve hashtags that relate to the post. Instead of putting them in the content of the post, put them in the comment section so people aren't flooded with your hashtags when reading the description of your post.
- For twitter it is recommended to use no more than three to four hashtags and only tag what's relevant.
- Hashtags are not very popular on Facebook, but try to add #ThisMumMoves and @ActivePregnancyFoundation, where ever possible.

Assets and Branding Guidelines

In order to maintain brand awareness, consistency in tone of voice, messaging and use of imagery, it is important to adhere to the **This Mum Moves™ Brand Guidelines,** which can be found in the digital toolkit.

When using images in social media posts, ensure:

- Images are inclusive and diverse.
- Images do not appear too posed and provide a realistic representation of what it is like to be active.
- They include women of different shapes, sizes, and ethnicities, and be clear and of high quality.
- A range of activities are shown, such as walking, taking part in an exercise class, being active outdoors and at home.
- Images show women in athletic and non-athletic clothing.
- Images of new mums also include activities with baby, and pram (buggy).
- Images of professionals and women are in both clinical and community settings.
- Examples of images can be found on the next page.